Experiment 7

Aim

To integrate Zoho Creator with external applications and services using Application Programming Interfaces (APIs) to enable secure data exchange, automate business processes, and extend the functionality of the Library Book Issue Management system. Zoho Analytics is used to build dashboards on the library data.

Introduction

API integration in Zoho Creator allows applications to communicate and exchange data with external systems. APIs enable developers to retrieve, create, update, and manage records between different applications. Zoho Creator supports API-based integration with external services, allowing developers to automate tasks, synchronize data, and improve application functionality.

Procedure

1. Log in to Zoho Creator and open the Library Book Issue Management application.
2. Identify the external application or service to integrate (Zoho Analytics).
3. Configure the required API access and authentication settings.
4. Generate or configure the necessary API credentials and permissions.
5. Use supported API requests or Deluge functions to send and receive data.
6. Configure the request URL, HTTP method, headers, and required parameters.
7. Test the API integration and verify that data is exchanged correctly.
8. Handle errors and validate responses to ensure reliable operation.

Applications of API Integration

- Connecting Zoho Creator with external databases and applications.
- Sending automated email notifications for due dates and overdue books.
- Synchronizing book issue records with the library catalog.
- Integrating payment gateways for fine collection or document verification services.
- Retrieving external data for reports and dashboards.

Workflow Chart

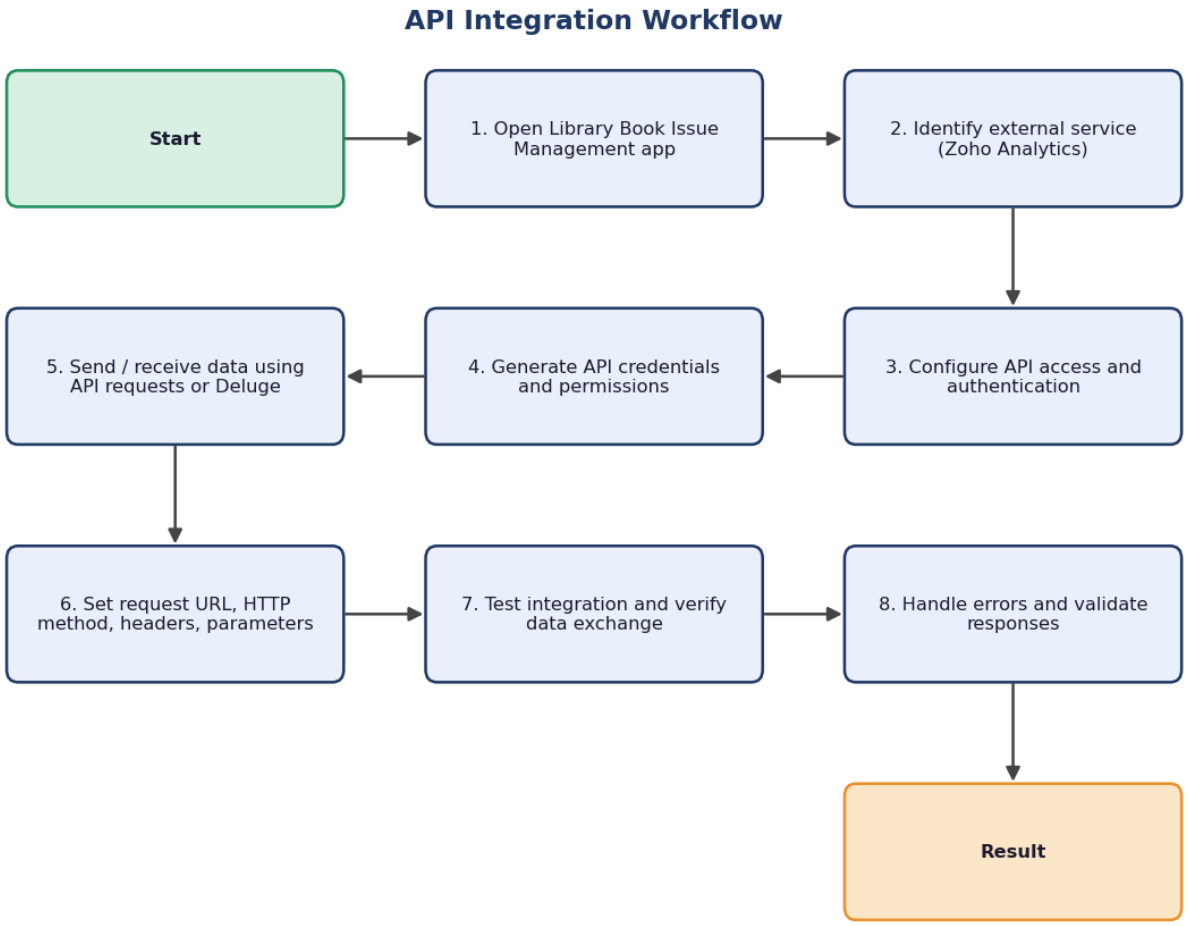


Figure 7-1: API integration workflow

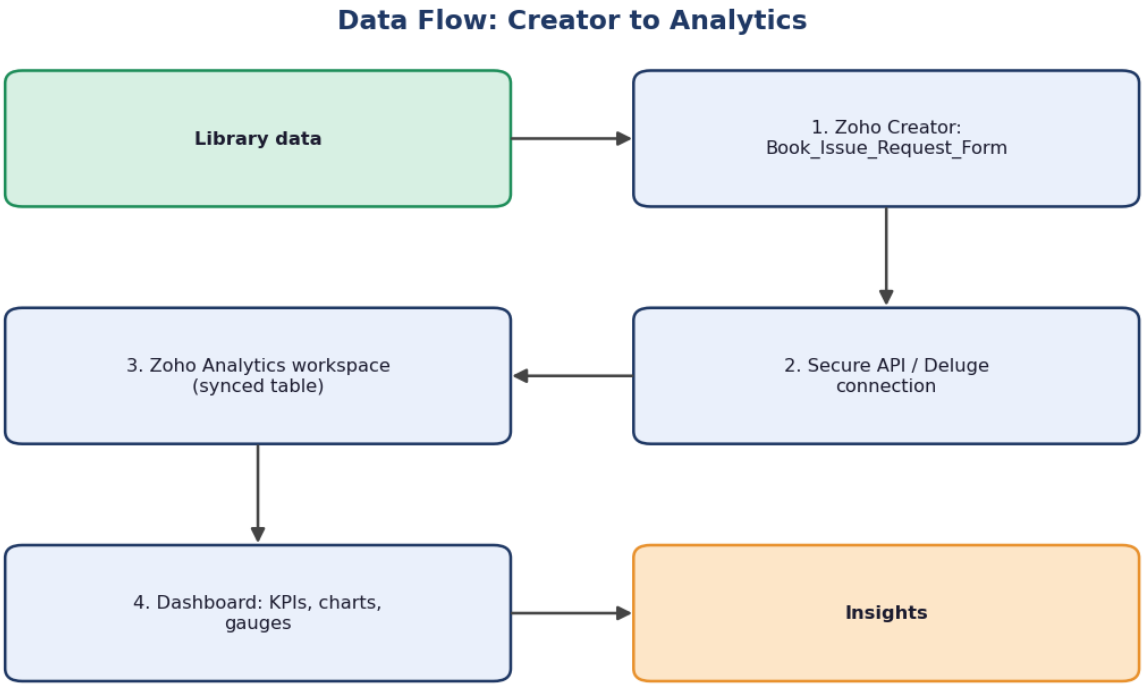


Figure 7-2: Data flow from Zoho Creator to Zoho Analytics

Conclusion

API integration in Zoho Creator enables seamless communication between applications and external services. It supports data exchange, workflow automation, and improved operational efficiency. By configuring APIs with appropriate authentication, validation, and error handling, developers can build more flexible and connected applications such as the Library Book Issue Management system.